

Screen Time Boundary System — Action Checklist

PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

AUDIT YOUR CURRENT SCREEN TIME

- ☐ **Track Screen Time:** Track exactly how much screen time your child actually gets for three full days before making any changes to your current setup.
- ☐ **Log Each Session:** Record what device was used, what content was watched or played, how long it lasted, time of day, your child's mood, and what triggered the end of each session.
- ☐ **Identify Patterns:** Look for specific times when tantrums occur, sessions that exceed 90 minutes, and mood changes that consistently happen before and after screen time.
- ☐ **Set a Realistic Baseline:** Establish a "good enough" goal for your family rather than aiming for zero screen time, which is neither achievable nor necessary for most families.

BUILD THE TRANSITION RITUAL

- ☐ **Use 5-2-1 Verbal Warnings:** Give your child explicit notice at 5 minutes, 2 minutes, and 1 minute before screen time ends so they can mentally prepare for the transition.
- ☐ **Set Up Visual Timers:** Install a physical Time Timer, phone alarm, or smart display timer so your child has a concrete, hard-to-ignore signal that time is ending.
- ☐ **Offer a Last Thing Choice:** Give your child a small sense of control by letting them choose to stop after one more episode or after finishing a game level.
- ☐ **Prepare a Post-Screen Activity:** Have a specific engaging activity ready before ending screen time so your child has something concrete to transition to rather than facing an empty void.

HANDLE RESISTANCE CALMLY

- ☐ **Stay Emotionally Regulated:** Keep your composure when your child protests or tantrums because your emotional regulation directly teaches your child how to handle disappointment.
-

- ☐ **Validate Their Feelings:** Acknowledge that it is hard to stop something fun without blaming or shaming them for having emotions, which helps prevent escalation.

 - ☐ **Follow Through Every Time:** Consistently enforce every warning and timer without exception because your reliability teaches your child to trust the system over time.

 - ☐ **Accept Normal Resistance:** Understand that occasional resistance is a natural part of the process and does not mean the system is broken—consistency matters more than perfection.
-

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.